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## True Story

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**Read the text. Then copy 1 to 10 words from the text that show that the statements below are correct. There is an example at the beginning (0).**

*Shappi Khorsandi: A Beginner's Guide to Acting English – The true story of a family on the run in a foreign country*

It wasn't just Maman and Baba's accent that made them different to our friends' parents. Maman kissed Rebecca and Susie when they came to play at Madeley Road. 'Don't kiss them, Maman!' I hissed at her. 'English people don't kiss!'

When I went to tea at Rebecca's, they had English food. Her mother asked if we wanted cheese sandwiches. 'Yes, please!' Rebecca answered for both of us.

It was fine by me; I loved cheese. But when Mrs Thompson brought in our plate of neatly cut triangles of white bread, what lay in the middle was not what I knew as cheese. It was yellow. Cheese was white at my house, white and crumbly, and we had it with strips of pitta bread or whatever Persian bread Baba could get his hands on. These yellow blocks of cheese were horrible. They were thick and rubbery and sat between two slices of bread so white and spongy it was more like foam. I learned to swallow without tasting.

'Thank you for the smashing tea!' I always said to Mrs Thompson, who thought I was very polite. I learned to say things like 'smashing tea' from my Enid Blyton books. [...]

Maman was still better than Baba at being English. At least she tried. For Baba, living in a country that wasn't Iran didn't make him think he had to act differently. He spoke to everyone as though he already knew them, he haggled in normal shops and haggled too much at our school car boot sales and he took very little notice of signs that said 'no parking' or 'out of bounds' and things like, always waving his hands up and tossing his head saying, 'Don't worry, no one will mind.'

Maman on the other hand, smiled a lot before she spoke, and she spoke quietly. She was still like Baba in some ways, of course. In Safeways, she went to the 'nine items or fewer' checkout even if she had at least fifteen items. Old ladies were always tutting at Maman and muttering, 'Bloody foreigner.'

Maman wore a headscarf sometimes if her hair wouldn't sit right that day. She didn't realise that it was okay if English mums wore headscarves, but on Iranian mums, they just looked really religious and everyone would stare and think she was a fanatic and I would die of embarrassment and pray that no one from school saw us.

Rebecca and Susie's dad said she was very 'charming' and Maman said, 'I just smile when I don't know what they are saying.' [...]

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|                                                                                                      | Words from the text                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| 0. The narrator's parents speak English in a strange way.                                            | Maman and Baba's accent ... made them different |
| 1. The way her mother greets her friends embarrasses the narrator.                                   |                                                 |
| 2. The narrator dislikes the taste of English cheese.                                                |                                                 |
| 3. She tries to behave like characters she has read about.                                           |                                                 |
| 4. Her father behaves as if he was still living in his mother country.<br>(Give <u>one</u> example.) |                                                 |
| 5. Her mother does not do what the shop signs say.                                                   |                                                 |
| 6. Some women disapprove of her mother's behaviour.                                                  |                                                 |
| 7. The narrator dislikes her mother wearing a headscarf.                                             |                                                 |